



Wickham Services Ltd — Brand Design System

Direction: Beacon — modern, premium, signal-clear digital field service. **Palette:** Deep blue + azure/cyan on dark navy. **Status:** v2.0 — supersedes v1.0 ("Kiosk", cobalt + signal orange). **Last updated:** 14 June 2026.

v2.0 supersedes v1.0. The brand has moved from the v1.0 "Kiosk" system (cobalt #1438A8 + signal orange #FF5722, Archivo Black WICKHAM SERVICES. wordmark, Bauhaus hard edges, *no gradients/glows*) to the "Beacon" identity: the **WS monogram roundel**, a deeper blue + cyan palette on dark navy, and a premium digital finish that *embraces* gradient, glow and depth. Where v2.0 and v1.0 disagree, **v2.0 wins**. The orange accent is retired.

This document is the single source of truth for all Wickham Services Ltd brand, web, and design decisions. Asset files + this document live in the **wickham-brand** repo and are served to every project over the **jsDelivr CDN** (see §13).

1. Brand Positioning

One-liner: A national field service operation, run like a software product.

What the brand stands for - Responsive. We answer, we turn up, we move. - **Visible.** Every job scheduled, dispatched, audited — you can always see where it is. - **Dependable.** We do the work, then we say what we did. Confidence without bluster. - **British and proud of it.** Hampshire-based, nationwide reach.

Tagline: *Responsive · Visible · Dependable.*

Audience - Primary: enterprise prospects — procurement leads, facilities/ops directors at Royal Mail, Evri, retail estates and similar national networks. - **Secondary:** engineers and the internal team — anything we publish should make them proud to be on the badge.

Tone of voice (*carried over from v1.0 — still true*) - Sounds like us: *Show up. Sort it. Move on.* Plain English. Understatement over hyperbole. Numbers when they earn it. - Doesn't sound like us: buzzwords, stacked adjectives, exclamation marks, brochure-speak.

2. Logo System

The logo is the **Beacon "WS" monogram** — a circular badge that reads as a signal/beacon.

Anatomy - A dark-navy **roundel** (self-contained, so it works on any background). - A **chevron "W"** in a blue→cyan gradient beside an **upright white "S"** — the WS monogram. - Three concentric **rings**, and three **cyan beacon dots** sitting on those rings, fading outward (a "signal pulse"). The beacon dots are the brand's **signature gesture** — they replace the old orange dot.

Variants (in order of preference)

Variant	Use case	Background
Mark (<code>wickham-mark.svg</code>)	App icon, favicon, avatar, embroidery, tight spaces	Any
Lockup — dark (<code>wickham-lockup-dark.svg</code>)	Site header, email sig, decks on dark	Navy / dark / photo
Lockup — light (<code>wickham-lockup-light.svg</code>)	Letterhead, light site header, print on white	Cream / white
Signature card (<code>wickham-signature-card.svg</code>)	Email signature, business-card front	Navy

Clear space — keep clear space equal to the **radius of the badge's inner disc** on all sides. Nothing intrudes inside that.

Minimum sizes - Mark: **24px** digital, **12mm** print. - Lockup: **120px** wide digital, **40mm** print.

Don'ts - Don't recolour the W gradient or the white S. - Don't remove or rearrange the beacon dots, or add more. - Don't stretch, skew, or rotate the badge. - Don't add a second accent colour — cyan is the only accent. - Don't recreate the wordmark in a different typeface. - Don't place the badge's glow over a busy photo — use a solid navy panel.

3. Colour System

The brand is **dark-first**: deep navy is the hero surface, cyan is the single accent ("the signal").

Name	Hex	Role
Deep Blue	#0E4F8B	Primary brand colour; wordmark on light
Azure	#16A6E8 / #3B82F6	W-gradient, highlights, hover
Cyan	#06B6D4 / bright #22D3EE	Beacon dots, links, the single accent
Navy	#0A0F1C	Primary dark surface / card field
Disc Navy	#111827	Badge disc, raised dark surfaces
Slate	#2D3A4F	Borders / dividers on dark
Cloud	#F8FAFC	Text & wordmark on dark; light surface
Muted	#94A3B8	Secondary text
Ink	#0F1729	Body text on light surfaces

CSS custom properties — drop straight into your stylesheet:

```
:root {
  --color-blue:      #0E4F8B;    /* primary brand */
  --color-blue-deep: #0B3C6B;
  --color-azure:     #16A6E8;
  --color-azure-2:   #3B82F6;    /* W-gradient start */
  --color-cyan:      #06B6D4;    /* accent / beacon */
  --color-cyan-bright: #22D3EE;  /* links on dark */
  --color-navy:      #0A0F1C;    /* hero surface */
```

```

--color-disc:      #111827;
--color-slate:     #2D3A4F;
--color-cloud:     #F8FAFC;
--color-muted:     #94A3B8;
--color-ink:       #0F1729;

/* Semantic aliases (dark-first) */
--bg:              var(--color-navy);
--surface:         var(--color-disc);
--border:          var(--color-slate);
--text:            var(--color-cloud);
--text-muted:      var(--color-muted);
--primary:         var(--color-blue);
--accent:          var(--color-cyan);
--link:            var(--color-cyan-bright);

/* Signature W gradient */
--grad-beacon:     linear-gradient(135deg, var(--color-azure-2), var(--color-cyan));
}

```

Usage - Lead with **navy + deep blue**; let **cyan** appear as a single confident accent (links, the beacon dots, one CTA). Cyan is the punch — don't scatter it. - **No orange**. It was the v1.0 accent and is fully retired. - Light surfaces are the *inverse* of the dark default (Cloud background, Ink text, Deep Blue primary, Cyan accent).

Accessibility — pairings meet WCAG AA at 16px+: - Cloud on Navy: ✓ high contrast. - Deep Blue on Cloud: ✓. - Cyan #22D3EE on Navy: ✓ (use the *bright* cyan for links on dark; the #06B6D4 accent is for fills/dots, not small text on dark).

4. Typography

Aligned with the live ops apps (replacing v1.0's Archivo / Cabinet Grotesk).

Role	Family	Weights	Source	Usage
Display / Headings	DM Sans	700, 800	Google Fonts	Headlines, hero, wordmark
Body	DM Sans	400, 500	Google Fonts	Running text
Mono	Space Mono	400, 700	Google Fonts	Codes, labels, the tagline/kicker

```

:root {
  --font-display: 'DM Sans', system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-body:    'DM Sans', system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-mono:    'Space Mono', ui-monospace, 'SF Mono', Consolas, monospace;
}

```

Rules - Headlines in DM Sans 700/800, sentence or title case (the maximalist all-caps of v1.0 is relaxed). - The **tagline / kickers** are always **Space Mono, uppercase, letter-spacing ~0.15em**, often in cyan — this is the connective tissue of the brand (e.g. RESPONSIVE • VISIBLE • DEPENDABLE). - Body always sentence case. Avoid italics.

Note: the current lockup wordmark is set in Arial as a system-safe placeholder. The intended wordmark face is **DM Sans 800**; redraw the wordmark in DM Sans when convenient and re-render.

5. Spacing & Layout (*carried over from v1.0*)

8px base scale (`--space-1: 4px ... --space-12: 160px`), `.container { max-width: 1320px; padding: 0 48px }` (24px on mobile), 12-column grid with 16px gutter, CSS Grid for layout.

6. Components

The v2.0 surface language is **soft depth and glow** (the *reverse* of v1.0's hard Bauhaus shadows).

Surfaces - Cards are navy (`--surface`) with a 1px `--border` and a soft glow; radius **12–16px**.

```
:root {
  --shadow-soft-sm: 0 4px 16px rgba(2,8,20,0.35);
  --shadow-soft-md: 0 10px 32px rgba(2,8,20,0.45);
  --glow-beacon:    0 0 40px rgba(59,130,246,0.18); /* signature glow */
}
.card {
  background: var(--surface);
  border: 1px solid var(--border);
  border-radius: 14px;
  box-shadow: var(--shadow-soft-md);
}
```

Beacon rings — concentric rings + fading dots are the signature decorative motif (they replace v1.0's tape strips and the orange disc). Use sparingly behind hero marks or as a section accent.

Buttons - Primary: deep-blue fill, cloud text, radius 10–100px. - Accent: cyan fill for the single key CTA per view. - One primary CTA per view; include an arrow → on the primary CTA.

7. Iconography (*updated*)

Stroked **Lucide** icons, **2px** stroke, rounded caps, 24×24 canvas. Accent strokes may use cyan. Never filled or three-tone. Sizes: 16px inline/buttons, 24px in cards, 32–48px hero.

8. Motion & Interaction (*updated*)

The brand now favours **smooth, premium motion** with subtle glow (v1.0's hard mechanical "snap" is relaxed). Gradients and glow are *on-brand*. - **Beacon pulse**: the dots/rings pulse gently outward (the signature animation). Subtle, then rests. - Buttons lift 2px; links get a cyan underline; cards raise with a stronger soft shadow. - Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` (disable transforms/animation).

9. Imagery & Photography (*updated grade*)

Documentary, not stock — engineers in vans, on ladders, at night. Real, flash-lit, contrasty. **Cool blue/cyan colour grade** (lifted navy/cyan shadows). Hero photography may carry a navy→cyan duotone or a soft glow overlay (now permitted). Avoid corporate-handshake clichés.

10. Voice & Copy (*carried over from v1.0*)

Short declaratives ("We do field service. Properly."), number-led ("1,400 sites. 120 engineers."), three-beat lists ("Show up. Sort it. Move on."). UK spellings, 24h times, 26.04.26 or 26 April 2026 dates, £ no decimals when whole, no Oxford comma, client names as they brand themselves. Footer tagline: **Responsive · Visible · Dependable.**

11. Web Architecture (*updated surface*)

Dark-first. Header: navy background, cloud text, **lockup-dark** on the left, one cyan CTA on the right. Sticky on scroll. Page heroes use a navy field with an optional beacon-ring motif. Pages, footer structure, and the page-hero pattern otherwise follow v1.0.

12. Technical Specifications (*carried over*)

Next.js / Astro or vanilla CSS with these custom properties; Vercel hosting; n8n intake on `automation.wickhamservices.co.uk`; Plausible analytics. Lighthouse 95+, LCP < 2.0s, CLS < 0.05. Modern evergreen browsers, WCAG 2.1 AA, visible cyan focus rings (`outline: 2px solid var(--color-cyan); outline-offset: 2px`).

13. Assets, File Naming & CDN

Single source of truth: the wickham-brand repo → served via jsDelivr. Base URL: `https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/wickham-brand@0.5.0/` (pin a tag, e.g. `@v2.0.0`, for production stability).

```
wickham-brand/  
  brand-system.md      ← this document (canonical)  
  svg/    wickham-mark.svg  wickham-lockup-dark.svg  wickham-lockup-light.svg  
          wickham-og.svg    wickham-signature-card.svg  
  web/    favicon.ico/.svg  favicon-16/32/48.png  apple-touch-icon.png  
          android-chrome-192/512.png  lockup-dark/light(.png/@2x)  site.webmanifest  head  
  email/  signature-card.png  mark-120.png (@2x)  
  social/ avatar-512/400.png  og-image-1200x630.png
```

Regenerate all rasters from the SVG masters: `npm run render (@resvg/resvg-js + png-to-ico)`. For print/vehicle vinyl, export EPS + high-res PDF alongside the SVG.

14. Dark / Light Mode

Dark is the **default** (navy hero is the brand's natural state). The light theme is the inverse: Cloud background, Ink text, Deep Blue primary, Cyan accent. Deep blue and cyan are stable across both.

15. Print & Physical Applications (*updated to v2.0*)

- **Vehicle livery:** navy base wrap, the WS badge large on side panels and rear doors, a single cyan

signal stripe, phone/ONE in Space Mono caps. Reflective strips for night visibility.

- **Apparel:** navy polos with the embroidered WS badge on the left chest; hi-vis with a navy + cyan heat-pressed badge on the back.
- **Business cards / letterhead:** navy face with the signature card; light reverse with the light lockup; contact details in Space Mono caps.
- **Email signature:** the navy **signature card** image (see <email/signature-card.png>).

16. Maintaining the Brand

Anyone making a brand decision should ask: 1. Is the surface **navy-first**, with **cyan as the single accent** (no orange)? 2. Is the type **DM Sans** (display/body) + **Space Mono** (labels)? 3. Is the logo the **Beacon WS** badge or an approved lockup — unaltered? 4. Is there exactly **one** primary CTA per view? 5. Does the cyan land as a single confident **signal**, not scattered? 6. Does it sound like a Hampshire engineer wrote it, not a London marketer?

If any answer is "no," it's drifting from the brand.

17. Changelog

- **v2.0 — 14 June 2026 — "Beacon".** New WS-monogram roundel logo; palette moved to deep blue + azure/cyan on dark navy (orange retired); typography moved to DM Sans + Space Mono; aesthetic reversed from hard Bauhaus to premium soft-glow/gradient; assets centralised in the [wickham-brand](#) repo + jsDelivr CDN. **Supersedes v1.0.**
- **v1.0 — 26 April 2026 — "Kiosk".** Cobalt + signal orange, Archivo Black [WICKHAM SERVICES](#). wordmark, Bauhaus hard edges. *Retired.*

Wickham Services Ltd · Brand Design System · v2.0 · 14.06.26
